Jobs in Aviation: Roles, Responsibilities & Operational Interfaces

Landside, Airside, Flight Crew, Air Traffic Services & Civil Aviation Corps (TSEEAC)

Target Level: CEFR B1–B2 • TSEEAC Airside Focus **Course:** GSEA Semester 1 (AT • LV121E) **Duration:** 120 Minutes (Full Block)

01 Session Learning Objectives

- ☐ **Aviation News:** Discuss current airline operations, staffing, and aerodrome headlines fluently.
- ☐ **Role Taxonomy:** Classify aviation personnel across 5 core domains without confusing jurisdictions.
- ☐ **Visual Profiling:** Describe the immediate responsibilities of 6 key professionals using authentic photos.
- ☐ **Functional Language:** Master spoken structures (*tasked with*, *responsible for*, *authority to*, *liaise with*).
- ☐ **Spoken Clue Quiz:** Explain mystery aviation roles under taboo constraints to build spontaneous fluency.
- ☐ **Crisis Negotiation:** Negotiate a winter weather diversion recovery matrix and conduct peer observation.

PART 1 Aviation News & Current Events Prompts

Work in pairs. Select one headline prompt and discuss operational ramifications for 3 minutes:

Headline A: Remote Tower Centers & Digital ATM

European regional airports increasingly transition to centralized remote digital tower hubs, altering the traditional physical workspace of AFISOs and ATCOs.

Prompt: How do high-definition optical cameras and infrared tracking assist situational awareness?

Headline B: Ramp Staffing & Turnaround Automation

Major European airlines partner with ground handlers to deploy semi-autonomous baggage belt loaders and robotic pushback tugs to combat peak-season ramp shortages.

Prompt: What safety responsibilities remain strictly with human Turnaround Coordinators?

RECALL Session 3 Ground Operations & GSE Vocabulary Spot-Check

Q1: What is the primary difference between chocks-on and chocks-off?

Chocks-on marks the official arrival when wheels are secured. Chocks-off marks off-blocks departure when all ground servicing is complete and pushback begins.

Q2: Why must handlers never approach an engine while anti-collision lights flash?

Flashing red beacons indicate engines are running or imminent start-up, creating severe ingestion hazards and lethal jet-blast danger.

Q3: Name two airside vehicles that operate directly at the fuselage service doors.

Catering hi-lift truck (servicing galleys) and ambulift / passenger boarding stairs (servicing main cabin doors).

Q4: Which conjunctions express cause vs. consequence in ramp safety reports?

Cause: 'due to', 'owing to', 'because of'. Consequence: 'consequently', 'as a result', 'resulted in'.

YOUR WARM-UP & SESSION 3 CATCH-UP NOTES:

PART 2 Aviation Operational Roles & Jurisdictions Reference Matrix

Aviation operations require seamless inter-agency handoffs across five distinct operational domains. Clear jurisdictional boundaries prevent safety gaps, misunderstandings, and runway incursions.

1. Landside Operations & Terminal Services
Passenger Service Agents (PSA), Security Screeners, Customs & Border Control, Terminal Duty Managers. Mandate: Passenger flows, document verification, baggage drop, and terminal security before the airside boundary.

2. Airside & Ramp Ground Operations
Turnaround Coordinators (TRC / Red Cap), Ramp Agents, Baggage Handlers, Aircraft Marshallers, Refuelers, De-icing Crew. Mandate: Physical aircraft turnaround on parking stands, GSE movement, loading balance, and pushback.

3. Flight Crew & Airline Ops
Captain (PIC), First Officer, Cabin Crew, Flight Dispatchers (OCC). Mandate: Safe navigation, FMC setup, final walkaround, weight & balance release, and operational control.

4. Air Traffic Control (ATS)
Tower Controller (TWR), Ground Controller (GND), Approach (APP), En-Route (ACC). Mandate: Legal authority to issue tactical separation instructions and clearances on manoeuvring areas and controlled airspace.

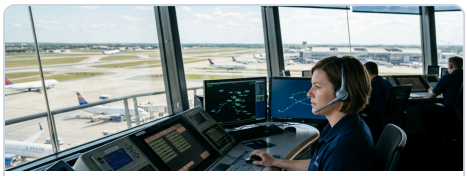
5. TSEEAC Civil Aviation Corps
AFISO, DGAC Safety Oversight Inspectors, Aerodrome Certification, Environmental Officers. Mandate: Essential advisory information at non-controlled aerodromes, regulatory audits, non-separation flight information.

Operational Domain	Key Job Roles	Legal Jurisdiction & Scope	Critical Handover Interface	Core Spoken Verbs
Landside / Terminal	Passenger Service Agent, Security Screener	Public concourse to boarding gate. Enforces baggage weights, identity checks, and security access.	Passes final passenger manifest and special assistance counts to TRC.	*screen, verify, check in, announce, board*
Apron & Ramp Ops	Turnaround Coordinator (TRC), Ramp Agent, Marshaller	Aircraft stand servicing envelope. Coordinates parallel GSE, cargo hold loading, and refueler.	Hands signed loadsheet to First Officer; signals "all clear" to pushback tractor.	*coordinate, supervise, load, marshal, push back*
Flight Crew & OCC	Captain, First Officer, Airline Flight Dispatcher	Flight deck and operational dispatch. Ultimate command authority for flight safety and route release.	Requests departure clearance from ATC; confirms aircraft status with TRC.	*calculate, program, inspect, cross-check, pilot*
Air Traffic Control	Tower ATCO, Ground Controller, Approach Radar	Active runways, taxiways, and controlled airspace (Classes A–E). Separation authority.	Transfers taxiing flights to TWR; issues takeoff and landing clearances.	*clear, instruct, separate, monitor, vector*
Civil Aviation Corps (TSEEAC)	AFISO, DGAC Safety Inspector, Aerodrome Officer	Regional aerodromes (non-controlled), regulatory oversight, airfield safety compliance.	Broadcasts runway surface conditions, wind, and traffic information to inbound pilots.	*broadcast, advise, audit, monitor, certify*

NOTES ON JURISDICTIONAL BOUNDARIES & TSEEAC NON-SEPARATION MANDATE:

PART 3 "What Do These People Do?" 6-Role Visual Profiling

Examine the 6 authentic documentary photographs of aviation professionals on duty. In pairs, observe their operational environment, specialized equipment, and immediate duties. Practice describing their responsibilities aloud using B2 structures.



01. Tower ATCO — SEPARATION

Workspace: Control Tower Cab (360° visual view)

Core Mandate: Issues tactical runway clearances and maintains legal separation between departing and arriving aircraft.

"They have authority to issue takeoff clearances and monitor active runway occupancy."



02. Turnaround Coord. (TRC) — APRON LEAD

Workspace: Apron / Aircraft Stand Charlie-4

Core Mandate: Orchestrates simultaneous ground handling teams (fueling, catering, baggage) to protect departure slot (CTOT).

"The TRC is tasked with coordinating ramp operations and liaising with the First Officer."



03. Airline First Officer — FLIGHT DECK

Workspace: Glass Cockpit / Aircraft Flight Deck

Core Mandate: Programs the Flight Management Computer (FMC), cross-checks performance data, and conducts walkaround checks.

"The First Officer is responsible for programming the route and verifying weight and balance."



04. AFISO (TSEEAC Corps) — ADVISORY

Workspace: Regional Aerodrome Operations Office

Core Mandate: Broadcasts essential traffic information, weather updates (METAR/SPECI), and runway surface state without separation instructions.

"AFISOs provide essential safety information, whereas ATCOs issue mandatory clearances."



05. Aircraft Marshaller — GROUND LEAD

Workspace: Apron Stand Lead-in Centerline

Core Mandate: Uses illuminated visual wands to guide aircraft precisely along stand lead-in lines to the designated nosewheel stop mark.

"They are responsible for guiding aircraft safely into parking stands and signaling chocks."



06. Passenger Service Agent — TERMINAL

Workspace: Terminal Departure Gate Concourse

Core Mandate: Verifies passenger boarding passes and travel documents, assists reduced-mobility passengers, and enforces cabin baggage limits.

"They are tasked with checking boarding passes and liaising with the ramp coordinator."

SPEAKING PRACTICE NOTES & ROLE DESCRIPTIONS DRAFT:

PART 4 Aviation Functional Language: Responsibilities, Authority & Prepositions

Professional aviation communication requires precise prepositions and modal structures. Avoid French false friends (*chargé de*, *responsable de*) and grammatical calques.

Rule 1: Duties & Tasks
be tasked with + -ing
be responsible for + -ing
❌ *responsible of*
✅ *The TRC is tasked with coordinating the turnaround.*

Rule 2: Legal Authority
have authority to + base verb
be authorized to + base verb
❌ *have authority of*
✅ *ATCOs have authority to issue clearance instructions.*

Rule 3: Lines of Communication
liaise with [peer / partner]
report to [hierarchical superior]
❌ *report with*
✅ *The First Officer reports to the Captain and liaises with the TRC.*

Job Role	Common Spoken Pitfall (French Calque)	Standard Operational Pattern (B2 Spoken English)
ATCO vs. AFISO	❌ *The AFISO is responsible of giving orders to separate airplanes.*	✅ *The AFISO is **responsible for providing** advisory traffic information, whereas ATCOs are **tasked with maintaining** separation.*
Flight Dispatcher	❌ *The dispatcher has the authority of cancel the flight without pilot.*	✅ *The flight dispatcher **has authority to amend** or delay the flight release in coordination with the captain.*
First Officer	❌ *The co-pilot reports with the captain and is in charge to load cargo.*	✅ *The First Officer **reports directly to** the Captain and **is in charge of cross-checking** the fuel balance.*
Marshaller	❌ *The marshaller is charged to guide the plane into the gate.*	✅ *The aircraft marshaller **is tasked with guiding** the aircraft along the lead-in line to the stop mark.*
Security Screener	❌ *Security officers have the authority of confiscate any baggage.*	✅ *Screeners **have authority to inspect** luggage and confiscate non-compliant hazardous materials.*
DGAC Safety Inspector (TSEEAC)	❌ *The inspector is responsible about auditing airlines and pilots.*	✅ *The TSEEAC inspector is **tasked with conducting** regulatory audits and verifying aerodrome certification.*

Spoken Delivery Practice (Say Aloud in Pairs):

1. "Who has legal authority _____ (halt / pushback) if a fuel spill is detected on stand?"
2. "The turnaround coordinator must liaise _____ (with / to) the OCC when baggage loading stalls."
3. "AFISOs are not authorized _____ (to issue / for issuing) mandatory heading vectors."
4. "Our TSEEAC team is tasked _____ (with / for) aerodrome lighting and obstacle limitation audits."

MY TARGET PREPOSITION SENTENCES & PRONUNCIATION NOTES:

PART 5 "Who Am I?" Progressive Clue Quiz & Spoken Taboo Challenge

Build spontaneous communicative fluency by describing aviation jobs under strict constraints. Practice without relying on forbidden vocabulary.

Two-Stage Fluency Game Rules: SPEAKING EXERCISE

Stage 1 (Progressive Clues): Student A reads Clue 1 (Worth 3 pts). If Student B guesses correctly, award 3 pts. If not, read Clue 2 (2 pts), then Clue 3 (1 pt).

Stage 2 (Taboo Challenge): Student A describes the mystery role for 45 seconds WITHOUT using any of the 3 Taboo Forbidden Words! Partner shouts "BUZZ!" if used.

Card 1: Mystery Job A

TABOO: RADAR, RADIO, AIR

- **Clue 1 (3 pts):** I work high above the airfield with an unobstructed 360-degree glass view.
- **Clue 2 (2 pts):** I decide exactly when flights can line up, take off, or land on active runways.
- **Clue 3 (1 pt):** I maintain visual contact with taxiing aircraft and issue runway crossing orders.

Answer: Tower ATCO (Aerodrome Controller)

Card 2: Mystery Job B

TABOO: PLANE, BAGGAGE, LATE

- **Clue 1 (3 pts):** I wear a high-visibility fluorescent vest and carry a timing clipboard on stand.
- **Clue 2 (2 pts):** I oversee fuel trucks, cargo loaders, and cabin cleaners working in parallel.
- **Clue 3 (1 pt):** My primary goal is completing ground servicing before the scheduled slot expires.

Answer: Turnaround Coordinator (TRC / Red Cap)

Card 3: Mystery Job C

TABOO: TOWER, SEPARATE, ORDER

- **Clue 1 (3 pts):** I work at regional aerodromes providing traffic and weather advisories to pilots.
- **Clue 2 (2 pts):** I broadcast runway surface state, wind direction, and local altimeter settings.
- **Clue 3 (1 pt):** I do not give mandatory instructions; pilots remain responsible for separation.

Answer: AFISO (TSEEAC Civil Aviation Corps)

Card 4: Mystery Job D

TABOO: STICKS, PARK, WALK

- **Clue 1 (3 pts):** I stand at the head-of-stand line wearing ear defenders and holding bright wands.
- **Clue 2 (2 pts):** Flight crews watch my visual hand signals to align their nosewheel on centerline.
- **Clue 3 (1 pt):** I cross my wands above my head to command an immediate emergency halt.

Answer: Aircraft Marshaller (Ramp Lead)

Card 5: Mystery Job E

TABOO: ROUTE, WEATHER, CAPTAIN

- **Clue 1 (3 pts):** I work inside the airline operations center hundreds of miles from the flight.
- **Clue 2 (2 pts):** I calculate fuel burn, check alternate diversion airfields, and file navigation plans.
- **Clue 3 (1 pt):** Both the pilot-in-command and I must co-sign the operational dispatch release.

Answer: OCC Flight Dispatcher

Card 6: Mystery Job F

TABOO: ICE, COLD, WING

- **Clue 1 (3 pts):** I operate an elevated cherry-picker basket during severe sub-zero winter spells.
- **Clue 2 (2 pts):** I spray heated glycol fluid across control surfaces to eliminate frost and snow.
- **Clue 3 (1 pt):** I calculate holdover time so flight crews know their takeoff window before refreezing.

Answer: De-icing Rig Operator / Specialist

Game Scoreboard: Student A: ____ pts / Student B: ____ pts

Taboo Penalties (Buzzes): Student A: ____ / Student B: ____

YOUR TABOO CHALLENGE ROLE DESCRIPTIONS DRAFT:

PART 6 Operational Crisis Decision Table & Peer Observation

Crisis Scenario: Stand Charlie-4 at 16:45. Rapidly deteriorating winter conditions with freezing rain. Flight ENAC-101 has 180 passengers onboard, while an inbound diversion reports a passenger medical emergency. Three competing bottlenecks threaten aerodrome gridlock. Coordinate multi-agency resolution:

Complication on Stand	Interfacing Agencies	Safety & Operational Regulation	Negotiated Recovery Sequence
Freezing Sleet & Ramp Slippery	TRC, Marshaller, Runway Sweeper, AFISO / TSEEAC	Braking action below medium-poor requires SNOWTAM update and reduced towing speeds.	Halt pushback on taxiway Kilo; deploy chemical de-icer to stand surface before tractor connects.
Inbound Medical Emergency Divert	Tower ATCO, OCC Dispatcher, Aerodrome Emergency Medical Lead	Medical divert has absolute air traffic priority over scheduled departures.	Reassign Stand Charlie-5 to divert; clear emergency corridor for airport ambulance.
De-icing Rig Shortage & Slot Risk	De-icing Rig Operator, TRC, First Officer, CFMU Slot Lead	Holdover time begins at start of final anti-icing step. Takeoff must occur inside window.	Perform remote pad de-icing near runway threshold to prevent holdover expiration during taxi.

Student B Peer Observer Rubric:

PEER ASSESSMENT

- ☐ **1. Operational Accuracy:** Speaker correctly distinguished between ATCO separation vs. AFISO advisory information.
- ☐ **2. Preposition Discipline:** Accurately used *tasked with*, *responsible for*, *authority to*, and *liaise with*.
- ☐ **3. Conciseness & Clarity:** Handover delivered calmly without hesitations, false friends, or filler words.
- ☐ **4. Closed-Loop Readback:** Confirmed understanding through clear questions or closed-loop confirmation.

YOUR FINAL NEGOTIATED MULTI-AGENCY CONSENSUS PLAN:

PART 7 Spoken Vocabulary Master Index, Syllable Stress & Self-Audit Log

Mastery of 18 high-frequency B2 aviation profession terms, word stress patterns, and continuous assessment benchmarks.

01. Jurisdiction (/ˌdʒʊər.ɪsˈdɪk.ʃən/)
Legal geographic scope of operational authority.

02. Separation (/ˌsep.əˈreɪ.ʃən/)
Mandatory minimum distance between aircraft.

03. Turnaround (/ˈtɜːn.ə.raʊnd/)
Ground servicing cycle between chocks-on and off.

04. Marshaller (/ˈmɑː.ʃəl.ər/)
Ground lead guiding aircraft using wand signals.

05. Dispatcher (/dɪˈspætʃ.ər/)
OCC flight officer planning routes and fuel load.

06. First Officer (/ˌfɜːst ˈɒf.ɪ.sər/)
Co-pilot sharing flight management and walkaround.

07. Clearances (/ˈklɪə.rəns.ɪz/)
Formal spoken authorizations issued by ATC.

08. Holdover Time (/ˈhəʊldˌəʊ.vər taɪm/)
Effective anti-icing fluid protection window.

09. Contingency (/kənˈtɪn.dʒən.si/)
Backup action plan prepared for emergency events.

10. Standoff (/ˈstænd.ɒf/)
Remote aircraft stand requiring bus transfers.

11. Oversight (/ˈəʊ.və.saɪt/)
Regulatory compliance supervision by DGAC/EASA.

12. Non-separation (/nɒn ˌsep.əˈreɪ.ʃən/)
Advisory service without tactical separation orders.

13. Subcontractor (/ˌsʌb.kənˈtræk.tər/)
Third-party handling or fueling company.

14. Liaison (/liˈeɪ.zɒn/)
Operational communication link between agencies.

15. Walkaround (/ˈwɔːk.ə.raʊnd/)
Pre-flight physical inspection of aircraft exterior.

16. Discretion (/dɪˈskreʃ.ən/)
Professional judgment during non-standard events.

17. Bottleneck (/ˈbɒt.əl.nek/)
Ramp operational stage causing downstream delays.

18. Pushback (/ˈpʊʃ.bæk/)
Tractor operation pushing aircraft into taxi lane.

Word Stress & Pronunciation Traps Spotlight:

- **ju-ris-DIC-tion:** Primary stress on 3rd syllable.
- **au-THOR-i-ty:** Primary stress on 2nd syllable (not 1st).
- **con-TIN-gen-cy:** Primary stress on 2nd syllable.

Continuous Assessment Self-Audit:

- ☐ I can articulate the exact legal differences between ATCO and AFISO/TSEEAC mandates fluently.
- ☐ I accurately use *tasked with*, *responsible for*, *authority to*, and *liaise with* in spoken sentences.
- ☐ I can negotiate a multi-agency recovery plan during an apron crisis and deliver a 60-second briefing.

PERSONAL ACTION TARGETS & CONTINUOUS ASSESSMENT PLAN: